



Alberta Public Health Disease Management Guidelines

Norovirus



This publication is issued under the Open Government Licence – Alberta (<http://open.alberta.ca/licence>). Please note that the terms of this licence do not apply to any third-party materials included in this publication.

This publication is available online at <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/norovirus>

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without written permission of Alberta Health, Government of Alberta.

© Copyright of this document and its contents belongs to the Government of Alberta.

For further information on the use of this guideline contact:

Health.CD@gov.ab.ca

Health and Wellness Promotion Branch

Public Health and Compliance Branch

Alberta Health

Norovirus | Alberta Health, Government of Alberta

© 2021 Government of Alberta | November 2021



Contents

Case Definition	4
Confirmed Case	4
Probable Case (Outbreak Only)	4
Confirmed Outbreak.....	4
Reporting Requirements	5
Laboratories	5
Alberta Health Services and First Nations and Inuit Health Branch	5
Appendix 1: Revision History	6

Case Definition

Confirmed Case

Clinical illness^(A) with laboratory confirmation^(B) of infection:

- Detection of norovirus nucleic acid (e.g., PCR) in stool

Probable Case (Outbreak Only)

Clinical illness^(A) in a person who is epidemiologically linked to a confirmed norovirus case

Confirmed Outbreak

Two or more cases of clinical illness^(A) compatible with norovirus that can be epidemiologically linked to one another (i.e., associated by exposure with onsets within a one to three day period), at least one of which is laboratory-confirmed:

Community Outbreak

- Two or more unrelated^(C) cases of illness compatible with norovirus that can be epidemiologically linked to one another

Institutional Outbreak

- Two or more cases of illness compatible with norovirus that are epidemiologically linked in an institutional setting

^(A) Clinical illness is characterized by acute onset of nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal pain, myalgia, headache, malaise, low grade fever or a combination of these symptoms, lasting 24–48 hours.

^(B) In general, laboratory testing is only performed in relation to gastrointestinal illness outbreak investigations.

^(C) Do not live in a common household, excluding institutions.

Reporting Requirements

Laboratories

All laboratories shall report all positive laboratory results in the prescribed form by mail, fax or electronic transfer within 48 hours (two business days) to the:

- Chief Medical Officer of Health (or designate), and
- Medical Officer of Health (or designate) of the zone.

Alberta Health Services and First Nations and Inuit Health Branch

- Report outbreaks only using the [Alberta Outbreak Report Form](#).
- Completion of a Notifiable Disease Report is not required.

Appendix 1: Revision History

Revision Date	Document Section	Description of Revision
November 2021	General	• Updated Template • Added web link to form
	Case Definition	• Added “(Outbreak Only)” to Probable Case for added clarity as it is only notifiable during an outbreak